

CHAPTER-4

MORALS AND MANNERS

Introduction

Through its teaching and training, Islam seeks to inculcate high morals in the people, especially in its followers. The purpose of the advent of the Prophets عليهم السلام sent by Allah Almighty was to save human beings from immoderation and to make them the possessors of good human morals. Some of the most important lessons in these high morals and manners are explained in this chapter, including; 'Importance of generosity and condemnation of Miserliness', 'Dignity of labour', 'Environmental pollution and Islamic teachings', and 'Human rights' (rights of relatives, guests and patients).

Objectives

By the end of this chapter, students will become aware of high human morals and manners. Moreover, they will be passionate about adopting these high morals and manners in their lives. This will make them practical Muslims who please Allah Almighty and good citizens of society.



1-Importance of Generosity and Condemnation of Miserliness



Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Describe the meaning and concept of generosity and miserliness.
- Understand the importance and significance of generosity and condemnation of miserliness.
- Write down the advantages of generosity and disadvantages of miserliness.
- Practice generosity and avoid miserliness in their daily life.

Meaning and Concept of Generosity:

Generosity means to fulfill the needs of the needy people for the sake of Allah Almighty. However, it should be kept in mind that generosity is not confined only to financial sacrifice but also includes benefitting others with all one's abilities.

Significance and importance of Generosity:

Islam emphasizes greatly on developing the high human value of generosity in the people. It gives the glad tidings of a great reward for generosity and declares it also an important means of gaining the pleasure of Allah Almighty. Allah Almighty declared generosity to be a debt to Himself which will be repaid in excess. Allah Almighty also declares generosity as a source of purification of soul. In one place, describing the qualities of the believers, the Holy Qur'an states:

وَمِمَّا رَزَقْنَاهُمْ يُنْفِقُونَ

Translation: 'And (the believers) spend out of what We have provided for them'. (Al-Baqarah: 3)

Declaring generosity as a debt, the Holy Quran states:

Translation: 'Who will lend a handsome loan to Allah, so that Allah will multiply many times over for him, and for such will have an honourable reward!' (Al-Hadeed: 11)

The Holy Quran says:

Translation: 'You can never attain righteousness until you spend in Allah's cause the things you love'. (Aal-Imran: 92)

It means righteousness can be attained only when one spends good things in the way of Allah Almighty because the thing which is lying idle is of no use.

It is stated in the Holy Quran:

Translation: 'He who gives from his wealth to purify himself'. (Al-Layl: 18)

It means spending in the way of Allah purifies one's soul.

The Holy Prophet ﷺ said regarding generosity:

‘A generous person is close to Allah Almighty, close to heaven, close to people and far from hell.’

Generosity and the Holy Prophet ﷺ:

The whole blessed life of the Holy Prophet ﷺ is a wonderful example of generosity. Undoubtedly, he was the most generous person. The Holy Prophet ﷺ did not leave any dirham or dinar behind at the time of his demise. He never repelled a beggar, nor did he disappoint him. He used to spend all his wealth on the needy and the poor. The Holy Prophet ﷺ used to say: ‘If I had as much gold as Mount Uhud, I would be happy when I would spend it among the needy people in three days.’ Once, the Holy Prophet ﷺ slaughtered a goat and distributed all its meat in the way of Allah Almighty and said: ‘The meat that was distributed is, in fact, the one that will survive.’ The Holy Prophet ﷺ said: ‘There are only two kinds of people to be envied, a man whom Allah has given wealth and he spends it in the way of Allah, and the other one is whom Allah has given knowledge and wisdom, and he makes decisions according to it and teaches it.’

Following the footsteps of the Holy Prophet ﷺ, the Companions also became the embodiment of generosity. They also did their best to serve the suffering humanity. The events of their generosity are evident in the Battle of Tabuk and other occasions.

Benefits of Generosity: Here are some of the benefits of generosity in following:

- Generosity brings love and pleasure of Allah Almighty.
- People also love those who are generous.
- Generosity brings peace and contentment to the heart.
- Generosity gets rid of bad habits like jealousy and arrogance.
- Generosity brings love to the poor and needy.

Condemnation of Miserliness:

Miserliness is the opposite of generosity. Miserliness means that a man does not spend on the legitimate needs of himself and the needy even though he has resources. Miserliness is a negative attitude that causes hatred, envy and malice in society. Miserliness is strongly condemned in the Holy Qur'an and Hadith. Describing the qualities of the disbelievers, Allah Almighty says in the Holy Qur'an:

الَّذِينَ جَمَعُوا مَالًا وَعَدَدُوا ۖ يُحْسِبُ أَنَّ مَالَهُ أَخْلَدَهُ ۖ

Translation: ‘Who accumulates wealth greedily and counts it repeatedly, does he think that his wealth will prolong his stay on earth forever?’ (Al-Humazah: 2-3)

The Holy ﷺ said: ‘A believer cannot be a miser.’

Islam teaches that Allah Almighty tests someone by giving more wealth and by giving less to someone. If Allah Almighty has blessed someone with wealth, he should be generous by spending in the way of Allah Almighty instead of spending only on his personal needs. If one does not have wealth, he should lead a life of contentment. Wealth is a great blessing of Allah Almighty. Its genuine gratitude is to spend it on the needy people in the way of Allah Almighty. Being a miser is ungrateful to the blessings of Allah Almighty. Allah Almighty loves generous ones and dislikes miser ones.

Disadvantages of Miserliness:

Following are some disadvantages of miserliness:

- Miserliness displeases Allah Almighty.
- Miserliness creates hatred in people.
- A miser person is mentally disturbed.

Summary of the Lesson

- Generosity is a high human value, and miserliness is a negative attitude. Therefore, Islam emphasizes generosity in its teachings and forbids miserliness.
- Generosity creates an atmosphere of peace, tranquillity, love and harmony in society, while miserliness leads to unrest, hatred and envy.

Therefore, we should be generous in our daily practical life and avoid miserliness so that our society can prosper.

Activity for the students

Students should make a chart of the social advantages of generosity and the social disadvantages of miserliness.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. Describe the meaning and concept of generosity.
2. Explain any three social advantages of adopting generosity.
3. Write down the translation of any one verse of the Holy Qur'an about generosity.

4. State any Hadith about generosity.
5. Which two men did the Holy Prophet ﷺ ask to be envied?

2. Fill in the blanks:

1. Adopting miserliness is _____ to the blessing of Allah.
2. Allah Almighty _____ the generous.
3. If a man does not spend on the legitimate needs of himself and the needy people even though he has resources is called _____.
4. Generosity means to fulfill the needs of _____ for the sake of Allah Almighty.
5. Islam teaches that Allah Almighty _____ someone by giving more wealth and by giving less to someone.

3. Tick ✓ the right answers and cross ✗ the wrong answers:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. Miserliness is a source of gaining Allah's pleasure.	☐	☐
2. The blessed life of the Holy Prophet ﷺ and his companions is a beautiful example of generosity.	☐	☐
3. Miserliness is a positive attitude.	☐	☐
4. Generosity is praised in the Holy Quran and Hadith.	☐	☐
5. Allah Almighty loves the generous person.	☐	☐

4. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
If someone does not have wealth,	at the time of his demise.
The Holy Prophet ﷺ said, 'the meat that was distributed'	which will be repaid in excess.
The Holy Prophet ﷺ did not leave any dirham or dinar behind	a source of the purification of the soul.
Allah Almighty declares generosity to be a debt to Himself	is, in fact, the one that will survive.
Allah Almighty declares generosity	he should lead a life of contentment.



Describe some events in front of students about the generosity of the companions of the Holy Prophet ﷺ mentioned in Ahadith.

2-Moderation

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Describe the meaning and concept of moderation
- Understand the importance and significance of moderation
- Adopt moderation in their life after knowing the benefits

Concept of Moderation:

The word 'Aitadal' is used in Arabic for moderation. In the Persian language, moderation is called 'Mayana Rawi'

Mayana Rawi literally means moderate conduct or way. It means one should adopt a moderate approach in each walk of life while avoiding extravagance.

Importance of Moderation:

Moderation is actually essential for a happy and successful life. No society can prosper with extravagance in any matter of life. Islam emphasizes the importance of this vital principle of life and teaches its followers to adopt it. In the Holy Quran, the name of the Muslim Ummah (nation) is mentioned as the 'Ummat e Wasat' (moderate nation):

وَكَذَلِكَ جَعَلْنَاكُمْ أُمَّةً وَسَطًا

Translation: 'Thus, We have appointed you a middle nation.'
(Al-Baqarah: 143)

History has shown that past nations have experienced extravagance in many facets of life. They deviated from the path of nature by adopting the method of extravagance in beliefs and worships, social and economic life. Islam, eliminating this extravagance, revived the natural teaching of moderation. In the light of Islamic teachings, moderation can be divided into the following three categories.

Moderation in Religion: The basic tenets of Islam include the spirit of moderation. Moderation is instructed in all acts of worship in Islam. During the lifetime of the Holy Prophet ﷺ, some of the Companions thought of taking the path of excess in worship. One of them said that he would pray all night. One said I would fast during the day, and another said I would not get married. When this news reached the Holy ﷺ, he said: 'Beware! I swear by Allah! I am the most to fear Allah among you and the most righteous, but I observe fast and leave, I also offer prayers at night and rest, and I also have married women. Thus, the Holy Prophet

صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ while teaching moderation, said: 'The most beloved deed to Allah is the most regular and constant even if it were little.' This is why Allah Almighty has permitted us not to fast while travelling.

Moderation in Society: Moderation in society means adopting a moderate approach in various aspects of life. When speaking, speak softly, instead of in a loud and harsh tone or a very low voice. In the same way, one should not overeat or eat so little that one becomes weak. Moderation should also be exercised in walking and driving. The Holy Qur'an says:

وَاقْصِدْ فِي مَشْيِكَ وَاغْضُضْ مِنْ صَوْتِكَ

Translation: 'Be moderate in your pace. And lower your voice.'
(Luqman: 19)

Regarding moderation, the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ has said:

مَا عَالَ مَنْ اقْتَصَدَ

Translation: 'He who adopts moderation will not be in need.'

Moderation in the Economy: Whether personal expenses of daily life or spending at home, a middle way should be adopted instead of extravagance or miserliness. Describing the attributes of believers, the Holy Quran states:

Translation: 'They are those who spend neither wastefully nor stingily, but moderately in between.' (Al-Furqan: 67)

Do not be a miser in charity, and do not spend all your money ignoring your children until you have to take a loan. In another place, it is commanded in the Quran:

'And do not make your hand [as] chained to your neck or extend it completely and [thereby] become blamed and insolvent.' (Bani Israil: 29)

Benefits of Moderation: Here are some of the benefits of moderation:

- By adopting moderation, a person does not need anyone (financially).
- Moderation creates consistency.
- By adopting moderation, one obtains the pleasure and love of Allah Almighty and tries to spend his life following the blessed life of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
- Moderation gives a person peace of mind and self-satisfaction.
- Adopting moderation saves society from chaos, civil war and misery.
- Moderation leads to the social, economic, social and cultural development of the country and the nation.

Summary of the Lesson

- Moderation is called equability. Islam teaches moderation in all matters of life.
- Moderation makes life happier and more successful. It creates peace, tranquillity and prosperity in society.

We get the message from these teachings that we should work with moderation and balance in all matters of life to live a happy and successful life and create peace and tranquillity and progress and prosperity in society.

Activity for the students

Hold a speech contest among students on 'Moderation in the Life of the Holy Prophet ﷺ.'

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. Describe the meaning and concept of moderation.
2. In how many categories is moderation divided in the lesson?
3. What does the Holy Quran say about the importance of moderation?
4. State the saying of the Holy Prophet ﷺ about importance of moderation in the lesson.
5. What is meant by moderation in society?

2. Tick ✓ on the right answer:

1. Mayana Rawi is a word of:
(A) Arabic (B) Persian
(C) Sindhi (D) Urdu
2. 'Aitadal' means:
(A) Moderation (B) Extravagance
(C) Conduct (D) Happy & Successful
3. Moderation in society means:
(A) Have balance in life (B) Take care of the neighbours
(C) Increase personal expenses (D) Practice worship of Islam
4. In the Holy Quran, 'Ummat e Wast' means:
(A) A nation that gives charity (B) A nation of worshipers
(C) A nation living in moderation (D) A nation of forgiving people

3. Fill in the blanks:

1. In walking and driving _____ should also be exercised.
2. It is said in the Holy Quran to be moderate in your _____.

3. The Holy Prophet ﷺ said: 'The most beloved deed to Allah is the most regular and constant even if it were _____.'
 4. The Holy Prophet ﷺ said that I offer prayers at night, and I also _____.
 5. Moderation is instructed in all acts of _____ in Islam.
4. **Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:**

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. <i>Mayana Rawi</i> is an Arabic word.	☐	☐
2. The most beloved deed to Allah is the most regular and constant.	☐	☐
3. Conversation should be in a loud or very low voice.	☐	☐
4. Moderation in this lesson can be divided into four areas.	☐	☐

5. **Match the words of column A with the words of column B:**

Column A	Column B
Past nations have experienced	equability
Avoid miserliness and extravagance	happier and more successful
Moderation means	as Moderate Nation
Moderation makes life	in charity also
The Holy Quran describes the Muslim nation	Extravagance in many facets of life.



Highlight the further benefits of moderation in front of students.

3-Equality

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Know the meaning and concept of equality.
- Describe the importance and significance of equality.
- Adopt the importance and significance of equality in their practical life.

Concept of Equality:

‘*Musawat*’ is an Arabic word which literally means ‘equality’. It means that all human beings have one origin, so they are equal in the eyes of the law, and they are also equal in rights. No one is inferior to anyone. The standard of greatness is based only on piety.

The Importance of Equality in Islam:

As Islam believes in monotheism, it is the flag bearer of the unity of human beings. It is repeatedly stated in the Holy Qur'an and traditions that Prophet Adam عليه السلام and Hazrat Hawwa (Eve) عليها السلام are the parents of the human race. The tribes and nations are there just for identification, so having pride on race is an insult to humanity. Allah says in the Holy Qur'an:

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ إِنَّا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ مِنْ ذَكَرٍ وَأُنْثَىٰ وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا إِنَّ أَكْرَمَكُمْ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ أَتْقَىٰكُمْ

Translation: ‘O mankind! We indeed created you from a man and a woman, and have made you into various nations and tribes so that you may know one another. Surely the most honourable among you in the sight of Allah is the one who is most pious among you.’

(Al-Hujurat: 13)

Thus, this verse tells us that the criterion of human greatness and nobility is not colour and race, but piety and righteousness.

The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ said about equality:

أَلَا أَفْضَلُ لِعَرَبٍ عَلَى عَجَبٍ وَلَا لِعَجَبٍ عَلَى عَرَبٍ وَلَا أَحْمَرٌ عَلَى أَسْوَدَ وَلَا أَسْوَدٌ عَلَى أَحْمَرَ إِلَّا بِالتَّقْوَىٰ

Translation: ‘An Arab has no superiority over a non-Arab, nor does a non-Arab have any superiority over an Arab; a white has no superiority over a coloured (black), nor does a coloured (black) have any superiority over a white; except by piety.’

When we look at Islamic worships, we find the practical manifestation of equality.

- In Prayer, all the worshipers stand shoulder to shoulder.
- In Fasting, all the observers of fast are seen in the same conditions.

- In Hajj, everyone wears the same style of dress, in the same place and utters the same Zikr (remembrance of Allah).

in رضى الله عنهم **and His Companions** - حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُوْلُ اللهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّيْنَ صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ **equality:**

- The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ was the best practical example of equality.
- The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ never hated anyone on the basis of colour, race and nationality.
- The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ has eliminated racial discrimination forever through his actions.
- The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ gave a great place to Hazrat Bilal Habashi رضى الله عنه, Hazrat Salman Farsi رضى الله عنه and Hazrat Sohaib Rumi رضى الله عنه
- Hazrat Bilal Habshi رضى الله عنه was appointed as Mu'azzin of Masjid e Nabawi which is a great honour.
- On the occasion of the Battle of Trench, the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ gave importance to the opinion of Hazrat Salman Farsi رضى الله عنه by digging trenches.
- The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ married his cousin, Hazrat Zainab رضى الله عنها with Hazrat Zaid bin Haitha رضى الله عنه who was his freed slave.

The above facts are great examples of equality of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ. Even in the matter of justice, the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ has always upheld equality. Once a woman named Fatima from Banu Makh'zum tribe was caught in theft. After the testimony of all the evidences and witnesses, the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ ordered the implementation of the Quranic punishment of cutting off her hand. People recommended that the sentence be commuted. The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ became extremely displeased on it and said: 'O people! The nations before you went astray because if a noble person committed theft, they used to leave him, but if a weak person among them committed theft, they used to impose the legal punishment on him. By Allah! If Fatima رضى الله عنها (the daughter of حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُوْلُ اللهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّيْنَ صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ committed theft, I would cut off her hand!'

The Companions رضى الله عنهم also practised equality, following the way of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ wholeheartedly. Hazrat Umar رضى الله عنه used to call Hazrat Bilal Habshi رضى الله عنه (ياسيدى!) (O' My master!). When Hazrat Umar رضى الله عنه was on his way to Jerusalem for the conquest of Palestine, he and his slave would ride on in turn, and he himself walked on foot. Hazrat Abu Zarr Ghaffari رضى الله عنه used to clothe his slave in the same dress he wore himself.

Benefits of Equality: Following are some benefits of equality:

- Equality develops mutual brotherhood and love.
- Equality establishes justice.
- Equality eliminates national, linguistic and racial prejudice.
- Through equality, differences and conflicts are eliminated.

Summary of the Lesson

- The Arabic word '*Musawat*' means equality. According to Islam, all human beings are equal. No one is inferior to anyone. It is against humanity to discriminate on the basis of colour, race, nation or creed.
- Prophet Adam عليه السلام and Hazrat Hawwa (Eve) عليها السلام are the parents of all human beings.
- Islam is a flag bearer of equality.
- The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ and his companions were practical examples of equality.

Islamic history is full of such bright examples, which are a beacon for us. In this era, there is a dire need for equality in our society so that the fire of prejudice and hatred can be eradicated from our society and peace and love become common.

Activity for the students

Students should have a debate among them on the topic of equality.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. Describe the meaning and concept of equality.
2. What word is used for equality in the Arabic language?
3. What did the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ say about the importance of equality?
4. Explain the criterion of greatness and nobility described in the Holy Qur'an.

5. Discuss any one example from the life of the Companions رضي الله عنهم about equality.

2. Tick ✓ on the right answer:

1. Musawat literally means:

- (A) To equalize (B) To increase
(C) To decrease (D) To differentiate

2. On the occasion of the battle of Trench, the Holy Prophet صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وأصحابه وسلم had trenches dug on the suggestion of:

- (A) Hazrat Suhaib Rumi رضي الله عنه (B) Hazrat Salman Farsi رضي الله عنه
(C) Hazrat Bilal Habshi رضي الله عنه (D) Hazrat Zaid bin Haris رضي الله عنه

3. Hazrat Umar رضي الله عنه used to call upon Hazrat Bilal Habshi رضي الله عنه as:

- (A) My Brother (B) My Friend
(C) My Master (D) My Slave

4. When Hazrat Umar رضي الله عنه was on his way to Jerusalem for the conquest of Palestine, he would:

- (A) Ride on, and the slave walked on (B) Walk on foot, and the slave rode on
(C) Make his slave sit on riding in turn (D) Ride on together with his slave and walked himself on foot

3. Fill in the blanks:

1. Hazrat Abu Zarr Ghaffari رضي الله عنه used to clothe his _____ in the same dress that he wore himself.
2. Hazrat Umar رضي الله عنه used to call upon Hazrat Bilal Habshi رضي الله عنه as _____.
3. The حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُوْلُ اللهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وأصحابه وسلم said: 'If _____ committed theft, I will cut off her hand!'
4. The Holy Prophet صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وأصحابه وسلم appointed Hazrat Bilal Habshi رضي الله عنه as _____ of Masjid e Nabawi.
5. The Holy Prophet صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وأصحابه وسلم married his cousin, Hazrat _____ with Hazrat Zaid bin Haitha رضي الله عنه who was his freed slave.

4. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. <i>Musawat</i> literally means equality.	☐	☐
2. All men are not equal in Islam.	☐	☐
3. The Holy Prophet ﷺ and his companions were practical examples of equality.	☐	☐
4. Hazrat Abu Zarr Ghaffari رضي الله عنه used to clothe his slave in the same dress which he wore himself.	☐	☐
5. The criterion of greatness and righteousness is not on piety.	☐	☐

5. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
The personality of the Holy Prophet ﷺ was	are seen in the same conditions.
The Holy Prophet ﷺ has eliminated	we find the practical manifestation of equality.
When we look at Islamic worships	stand shoulder to shoulder.
In Fasting, all the observers of fast	the best practical example of equality.
In Prayer, all worshippers	racial discrimination forever by his actions.



Highlight the social benefits of equality more in front of students.

4-Dignity of Labour

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Learn the meaning and concept of labour.
- Describe the dignity of labour.
- After knowing the benefits of labour, they play their role in the development of society as constructive individuals.

Meaning and concept of labour: Labor means pain and suffering. It means a person manages his livelihood by working hard with his own hands and fulfills all his chores himself.

Islamic Teachings about Dignity of Labour: Even before the creation of man, Allah Almighty, by His mercy and grace, provided all the necessities of man in this world so that he could easily settle his worldly affairs. The Holy Qur'an emphasizes earning by one's own hands. Allah Almighty says:

فَإِذَا قُضِيَتِ الصَّلَاةُ فَانتَشِرُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ وَابْتَغُوا مِنْ فَضْلِ اللَّهِ وَاذْكُرُوا اللَّهَ كَثِيرًا لَعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ

Translation: 'Once the prayer is over, disperse throughout the land and seek the bounty of Allah. And remember Allah often so you may be successful'. (Al-Jumua: 10)

Prophets عليهم السلام also earned a livelihood by their own hands. They never asked for wages to convey the message of Allah Almighty. The Holy Qur'an says: **Translation:** 'Say O Messenger! I ask no reward for it from you.' (Al-An'aam: 90)

The best people in the world are prophets who all worked hard to earn a living.

Prophet Adam عليه السلام used to cultivate. Prophet Noah عليه السلام was a carpenter. Prophet Idrees عليه السلام was a tailor. Prophet Dawood عليه السلام used to make armours. Prophet Musa عليه السلام used to graze goats, and the Last Prophet حضرت محمد ﷺ also grazed goats and traded. It turned out that these excellent human beings themselves did not feel any shame in earning through hard work, but they did it with pride. The Holy Prophet ﷺ highlighted the dignity of labour, saying:

الْكَاْسِبُ حَبِيبُ اللَّهِ

Translation: 'One who works hard is a friend of Allah'.

On another occasion, the Holy Prophet ﷺ stated: 'No one eats better food than that which he eats out of the work of his hands.'

While teaching the value of hard work and the value of labour, he further said: 'Pay the labour his wages before his sweat dries.'

The Holy Prophet ﷺ disliked begging and said:

أَلَيْدُ الْعُلْيَا خَيْرٌ مِنَ أَلَيْدِ السُّفْلَى

Translation: The upper hand (i.e., helping hand) is better than the lower hand (i.e., begging hand)'.

Benefits of Labour:

There are many social benefits of labour. Some of them are as follows:

- Labour creates self-respect in man.
- It keeps a person active and saves him from illness and laziness.
- A hardworking man is saved from begging to someone.
- It brings progress and prosperity in society.

Summary of the Lesson

- Prophets of Allah also earned their livelihood by working hard. None of them felt ashamed to work hard.
- Islam dislikes begging to a person and emphasizes on hard work.
- Hard work benefits not only the hard worker but also the country and the nation's progress.
- We should not underestimate any hard worker but respect him.

We got the message from this lesson that we should work hard, work by ourselves and give up the habit of laziness. Do not consider any profession inferior and do not consider those who work hard as inferior to anyone, but respect them all.

Activity for the students

Every student should talk about him/herself, what type of hard work he/she will adopt in the future and how he/she will serve society.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. What is the literal meaning of labour?
2. Describe the concept of labour.
3. State the personal and social benefits of labour.
4. What does the Holy Qur'an teach about labour?
5. What is the teaching of the Holy Prophet ﷺ about labour?

2. Fill in the blanks:

1. Labour creates _____ in man.
2. No one eats better _____ than that which he eats out of the work of his hand.
3. The Holy Prophet ﷺ _____ begging.
4. Hard-working brings _____ in the society.
5. The Holy Prophet ﷺ said: 'Pay the labour his wages before his _____ has dried.'

3. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. Hazrat Adam عليه السلام used to graze goats.	☐	☐
2. Hazrat Noah عليه السلام used to trade.	☐	☐
3. Hazrat Idrees عليه السلام was a tailor.	☐	☐
4. Hazrat Dawood عليه السلام used to make armour.	☐	☐
5. Hazrat Musa عليه السلام used to cultivate.	☐	☐

4. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
Labour means	also grazed goats.
A hardworking person saves	are the Prophets.
The best people of the world	from begging to someone.
حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ	he eats out of the work of his hand.
No one eats better food than that which	pain and suffering.

**Instruction
for the
teachers**

The teachers should deliver a lecture to the students on the topic 'Importance of Labour for Education' so that they develop a hatred of cheating culture and concentrate fully on their education.



5-Environmental Pollution and Teachings of Islam



Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Know the concept and types of environment and pollution.
- Describe their environment by developing awareness.
- Understand and write down environmental pollution and the teachings of Islam.
- Explain the importance of protecting the environment from pollution.
- Strive to keep themselves and the environment clean.



Concept of Environment: The things in our surroundings are called 'environment'.

Concept of Pollution:

The inclusion of substances in our environment that harm human health is called 'environmental pollution'. Environmental pollution is extremely harmful to humans and other living things in the world. The measures are being taken at the international level to protect the environment from this pollution so that human beings and other living creatures may live in the world. Awareness is being raised all over the world regarding environmental pollution, and billions of rupees are being spent on making the environment clean and tidy.

Islam is a complete code of life. Islam emphasizes not only the prosperity of the Hereafter, but it is also a flag-bearer of the prosperity and well-being of human life in this world. Since Environmental Pollution is very harmful to human life and its well-being, the teachings of Islam emphasize keeping the environment clean and free from all kinds of pollution. The Holy Qur'an states:

وَاللَّهُ يُحِبُّ الْمُطَهِّرِينَ

Translation: 'And Allah loves those who purify themselves'.

(Al-Tawbah: 108)

When each one of us takes care of purification and cleanliness, it will affect our environment positively. Thus, our environment will be protected from pollution. Islam strictly forbids the spread of corruption, which does not limit itself to looting or bloodshed but polluting the environment is also corruption. The Holy Qur'an states:

Translation: 'And Allah does not like corruption'. (Al-Baqarah: 205)

The Holy Prophet ﷺ said:

الطُّهُورُ شَطْرُ الْإِيمَانِ

Translation: 'Purification is a part of faith.'

Some types of environmental pollution are as follows:

Air Pollution: Our air is polluted by toxic fumes from industries, vehicle fumes, and tobacco. This pollution causes disease in the skin, ears, nose and eyes. Planting trees is beneficial in preventing air pollution. Trees absorb carbon dioxide, which humans and animals release, and release oxygen, which helps living things breathe.

The Holy Prophet ﷺ said:

مَا مِنْ مُسْلِمٍ يَغْرِسُ غَرْسًا أَوْ يَزْرَعُ زَرْعًا فَيَأْكُلُ مِنْهُ طَيْرٌ أَوْ إِنْسَانٌ أَوْ بَهِيمَةٌ إِلَّا كَانَ لَهُ بِهِ صَدَقَةٌ

Translation: 'If a Muslim plants a tree, or sows a field and then a bird, or a person or an animal eat from it, all of it is charity from him.'

Water Pollution: Aquatic pollution is called water pollution. Water is the basis of life on this earth. Toxic water from industries, unnecessary use of chemical fertilizers, and dumping garbage in oceans and rivers spread water pollution. This pollution makes not only water unusable for humans, but it is also extremely harmful to aquatic life. From aquatic life, man uses many things as his food, such as fish. Due to water pollution, this food is no longer eatable for human beings. Therefore, the Holy Prophet ﷺ has emphasized keeping the water clean and pure. The Holy Prophet ﷺ said:

اتَّقُوا الْمَلَاعِينَ الثَّلَاثَةَ الْبَرَّازَ فِي الْمَوَارِدِ وَقَارِعَةَ الطَّرِيقِ وَالظِّلَّ

Translation: 'Guard against the three things which cause curse: defecating at the watering-places, in the middle of the road and under a shady tree'.

Noisy Pollution: Annoying sound is called noisy pollution. Excessive sound becomes noisy and pollutes the environment. It causes people to become nervous and suffer from psychological diseases. Vehicle noise and their pressure horns

and excessive use of loudspeakers cause noise pollution.

It is stated in the Holy Quran:

Translation: 'And lower your voice, for the ugliest of all voices is certainly the braying of donkeys'. (Al-Luqman: 19)

The Holy Prophet ﷺ used to talk in a moderate voice usually. In the light of Islamic teachings, the best man is the one who benefits other people. The Holy Prophet ﷺ said:

Translation: 'The best among people is the one who benefits people.'

Summary of the Lesson

- The inclusion of substances in the environment that harm human health is called 'Environmental Pollution.'
- Environmental pollution is not only extremely harmful to human health but also harmful to all living things.
- Polluting the environment is like spreading corruption on the earth.
- Islam teaches us to keep the environment clean and free from all kinds of pollution so that it can be saved from pollution and man can live a happy and comfortable life.

We should not burn garbage near the population nor throw it into the water. We should use loudspeakers as less as possible and use vehicles that do not discharge smoke. The most incredible goodness for man in the present age is to protect the environment from all kinds of pollution so that he can live a healthy life and better prepare for the accountability of the Hereafter.

Activity for the students

Every student should mention at least one thing that pollutes the environment and discuss its prevention.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. What is meant by environmental pollution?
2. How many types of environmental pollution are there?
3. According to Islam, why is it disliked to pollute the environment?
4. How can we save the air from pollution?
5. How does noisy pollution spread out?

2. Fill in the blanks:

1. We should not burn _____ near the population.
2. Do not use loudspeaker _____.
3. Use those vehicles that do not discharge _____.
4. The Holy Prophet ﷺ said: 'The best among people is the one who _____ people.'
5. The Holy Prophet ﷺ has emphasized on keeping the water _____.

3. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. The things in our surroundings are called 'environment'.	☐	☐
2. Allah Almighty does not like corruption.	☐	☐
3. Trees absorb oxygen.	☐	☐
4. Pollution is the basis of life on this earth.	☐	☐
5. Due to water pollution, seafood is no longer eatable for human beings.	☐	☐

4. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
Noisy pollution	plantation is very beneficial.
For the prevention of Air Pollution,	as <i>Sadaqah Jariah</i> (continuous charity).
Trees absorb	means annoying sound.
The Holy Prophet ﷺ has declared plantation	Carbon dioxide.



Teachers should explain to the students that the Holy Qur'an commands us to get purification through Wudu (ablution) and Ghusl (bath). Similarly, the Prophetic traditions also command us to be pure and clean. This is the best way to be saved from environmental pollution.

6-Human Rights

(Relatives, Guests and Patients)

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Know the meaning and concept of Human Rights.
- Describe the importance and rights of relatives, guests and patients.
- Play a role in establishing a peaceful society by fulfilling human rights.

Meaning and concept of *Huquq-ul-Ibad* (Human Rights):

'*Huquq*' is the plural of the Arabic word '*Haq*'. '*Haq*' literally means 'Proven thing and privileges'. '*Huquq-ul-Ibad*' (Human Rights) refers to the privileges enjoined by Allah Almighty on the people for each other. The right of one person becomes the responsibility of another person.

There are two types of rights: one is the Rights of Allah, and the other is Human Rights. Rights of Allah refer to our responsibilities towards Allah, which Islam commands us and Human Rights are those responsibilities towards people that Islam enjoins us.

Islam greatly emphasizes the fulfillment of human rights. Moreover, it is necessary to take care of human rights for the prosperity, well-being, peace and development of any society. A society where people conscientiously take care of one another's rights becomes a prosperous society.

Among the rights of human beings, the rights of three people are very important; relatives, guests and patients. Relatives include paternal and maternal uncles, aunts and cousins etc.

Rights of Relatives: Relatives are of paramount importance in human relations. That is why in the Holy Qur'an and Ahadith, their rights are placed at the forefront. Some of the rights of relatives are as follows:

- Share in their sorrows.
- Treat them with kindness.
- Help them in difficult times.
- Avoid troubling them in any way.

The Holy Qur'an states:

وَاتِ ذَا الْقُرْبَىٰ حَقَّهُ

Translation: 'And give the relative his right'. (Bani Israel: 26)

Believers are commanded to maintain ties of kinship with their relatives, and it is strictly forbidden to break the ties. Breaking up of relationships is mentioned in the Holy Qur'an as a sign of hypocrites:

Translation: ‘And they break whatever ties Allah has ordered to be maintained’.
(Al-Baqarah: 27)

Describing the importance of maintaining ties of kinship with relatives, the Holy Prophet ﷺ said: ‘The one who breaks the tie of kinship will not enter Paradise.’

The Holy Prophet ﷺ was very much concerned about the rights of relatives. He used to stand up to welcome his foster mother Bibi Halima Sadia رضى الله عنها and his foster sister Hazrat Sheema رضى الله عنها, spread his sheet for them, accompany them far away while leaving and listen to them carefully.

Rights of Guest: In good societies, a guest is respected and treated with hospitality. Hospitality is the Sunnah of the Prophets. The Holy Qur'an mentions the hospitality of Prophet Ibrahim عليه السلام. The Holy Prophet ﷺ was a great host. About respect of guests he said, ‘And he who believes in Allah and the Last Day let him respect his guests.’

The Holy Prophet ﷺ used to take complete care of his guests. Islamic teachings show that the guest should also take care of his host and should not ask such a thing which would cause him inconvenience, and should not stay with his host for more than three days. He should not go to the host at such times that make him feel uncomfortable.

In the light of Islamic teachings, the guest has rights over the host, some of which are:

- To respect the guest.
- To show hospitality in his capacity.
- To take care of the comfort of the guest.
- Not to make a distinction between the rights of Muslims and non-Muslims.

Rights of Patient: The Holy Prophet ﷺ, without any discrimination, used to visit Muslims and non-Muslims in their illness and even he used to visit his enemies who fell ill.

There are many rights of a patient, some of which are as follows:

- If a person becomes ill, one who can afford, should get him treated to the best of his capacity.
- When he becomes ill, visit him.
- To make Dua for his recovery while visiting.
- Not to sit with him for a long time after visiting because he is in discomfort.

- To support and encourage him in this difficult moment.
- To help him as per need.

Summary of the Lesson

- The rights of relatives, guests and patients have great importance in Islam. Conscientious Care of human rights develops peace and tranquillity in society. Consequently, the country and the nation get success with this.
- A society where people conscientiously take care of one another's rights becomes a prosperous society.

We should fulfill the rights of our relatives, guests and patients to obtain the pleasure of Allah Almighty. This act also promotes love and affection and establishes peace and tranquillity.

Activity for the students

Every student should visit an ill person in his / her neighbourhood. They can also visit any of their relatives. Students will describe their experience to their classmates in the classroom.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. What is the meaning and concept of *Huqul Ibad*?
2. State any three rights of relatives.
3. What are the rights of guests? Discuss any three of them.
4. What did the Holy Prophet ﷺ say about the rights of patients?
5. Mention the practical example from the life of the Holy Prophet ﷺ about the rights of relatives.

2. Fill in the blanks:

1. When someone becomes ill, _____ him.
2. Guests should also take care of his _____.
3. _____ has been commanded with the relatives.
4. The Holy Prophet ﷺ was a great _____.

3. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. The literal meaning of <i>Haq</i> is Justice.	☐	☐
2. There are two types of rights; i) Rights of Allah ii) Human Rights.	☐	☐
3. In human relations, friends have the most important value.	☐	☐
4. We should break ties with relatives.	☐	☐
5. Guests are respected in a good society.	☐	☐

4. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
The act of visiting a patient	guests are respected
The hospitality of Prophet Ibrahim عليه السلام	is the sunnah of the Prophets.
In good societies	will not enter Paradise.
Hospitality	is mentioned in the Holy Qur'an.
The one who breaks ties	is liked by Allah Almighty greatly.



Highlight further details of the rights mentioned in traditions about relatives, guests and patients in front of the students.